Radicals

Many chemical **compounds** contain a chemical **radical**. A chemical radical is a group of atoms that tend to stay together when the compound reacts with another compound. The names of many chemical compounds include the name of the radical they contain.

☞ **1** Complete the table below. The first one has been done for you.

Name of common radical	Formula of radical	Contains
carbonate	CO_3	1 atom of carbon, 3 atoms of oxygen
hydrogen carbonate	HCO_3	
hydrogen sulfate	HSO_4	
hydroxide	OH	
nitrate	NO_3	
sulfite	SO_3	
sulfate	SO_4	
ammonium	NH_4	
phosphate	PO_4	

2 Circle the correct formula for each of the following compounds. Use the table in question 1 to help you.

a	magnesium carbonate	$MgCO_2$	MgCO	$MgCO_3$
b	zinc sulfate	$ZnSO_3$	$ZnSO_4$	$ZcSO_4$
c	ammonium chloride	NH_4Cl	NH_3Cl	NH_4CL
d	potassium nitrate	KNO_2	KNO_3	PNO_3
e	sodium hydrogen carbonate	$SHCO_3$	$NaHCO_2$	$NaHCO_3$
f	sodium hydroxide	SOH	NaOH	NaHO

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